IFDO Survey on Research Funders' Data Policies

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IASSIST

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The Context is Changing

A common understanding internationally that data is a key element of a functioning research infrastructure

A common recognition that research contributions and returns of public investments are limited

A growing acknowledgement that existing access mechanisms and solutions do not work

An increasing political will to use strong incentives; changing legislation and establishing new funding schemes to support and enforce data access and data sharing

IFDO Survey on Research Funders' Data Policies

- Country-by-country information on current institutional research data policies
- Main focus on formal data policies
- Existence, contents and quality of data sharing requirements
- Type of linkage to funding

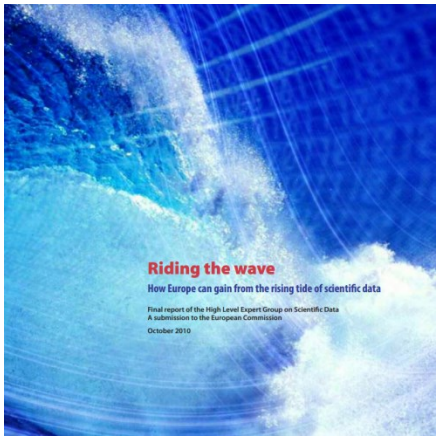
IFDO Survey on Research Funders' Data Policies

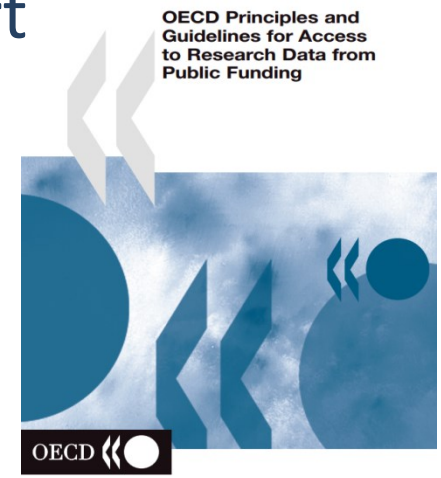
- From May 2012 to January 2013, survey invitations were sent to potential respondents from 90 different countries
- As of May 2014, 43 individuals from 32 countries have completed the survey
- Though most participating countries are represented by one respondent, 10 have multiple respondents

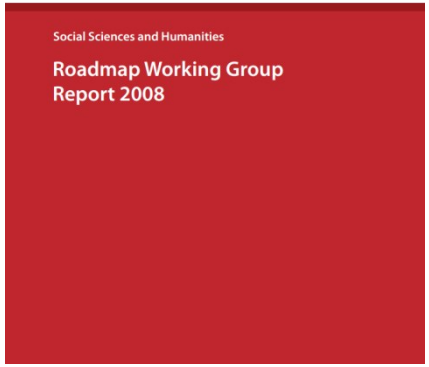
The IFDO Report

1. Introduction
2. Why Data sharing and why Data Policies?
    - 2.1 Challenges to data creation
    - 2.2 Data sharing and trust
    - 2.3 International data policy initiatives
    - 2.4 Examples of research funders policies
3. Survey Findings
4. Conclusions

Initiatives Assessed in the IFDO-Report







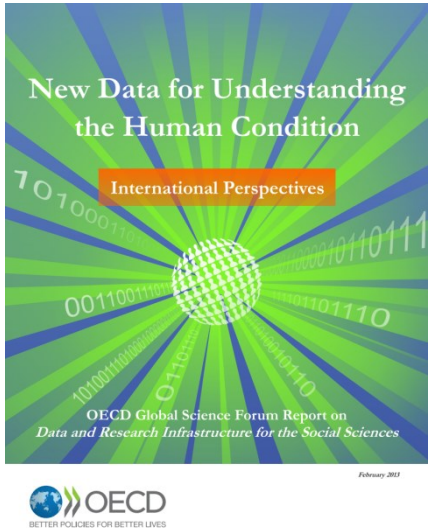


Table 1: summary of challenges and recommendations from the OECD Global Science Forum Report

Challenge	Recommendation	Main actors
Reliability, statistical validity and generalizability of new forms of digital data	Collaborate internationally to provide resources (methods and tools) for researchers	National research funding agencies
Information about the existence of micro-data and their availability	Data should be processed and documented to agreed and common standards	National and international statistical organisations
Privacy of individuals	Collaboration to develop an internationally recognised framework code of conduct for research use of new forms of personal data	Research funding agencies and data protection authorities
Barriers to access (legal, cultural, language, proprietary rights)	Cooperation on mechanisms to improve access for comparative research	National statistical agencies and international agencies (e.g. World Bank, WHO, OECD)
Increasingly interdisciplinary research agenda	Share expertise, knowledge and resources, particularly in the areas of data access, linkage, integration and analysis	Data producers and data users
Increased focus on cross-country comparative research	Harmonise social and economic data; foster an integrated approach to data design and harmonisation, access and sharing	National and international statistical agencies, researchers and research funders
Re-usability of data	Requirements for researchers to make data management plans	National funding agencies
Resources and infrastructures connected to professional data preservation and curation	Assessment of national needs and assets that will contribute to national plans of action	Social science research communities
Ensure effective data sharing	Incentives to ensure data sharing, through common systems for referencing and recognizing data resources in research publications	Research funding agencies, publishers of research and employers of researchers

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Examples of Research Funders Policies

Policy statements from national funders can be divided into three categories or groups:

- those who have explicit policies on data sharing and clear implementation of these policies (e.g. by specifying where data should be deposited);
- those who have explicit polices but no clear implementation;
- those who have no explicit data sharing policy statements.

Research Funders Policies – Major Findings

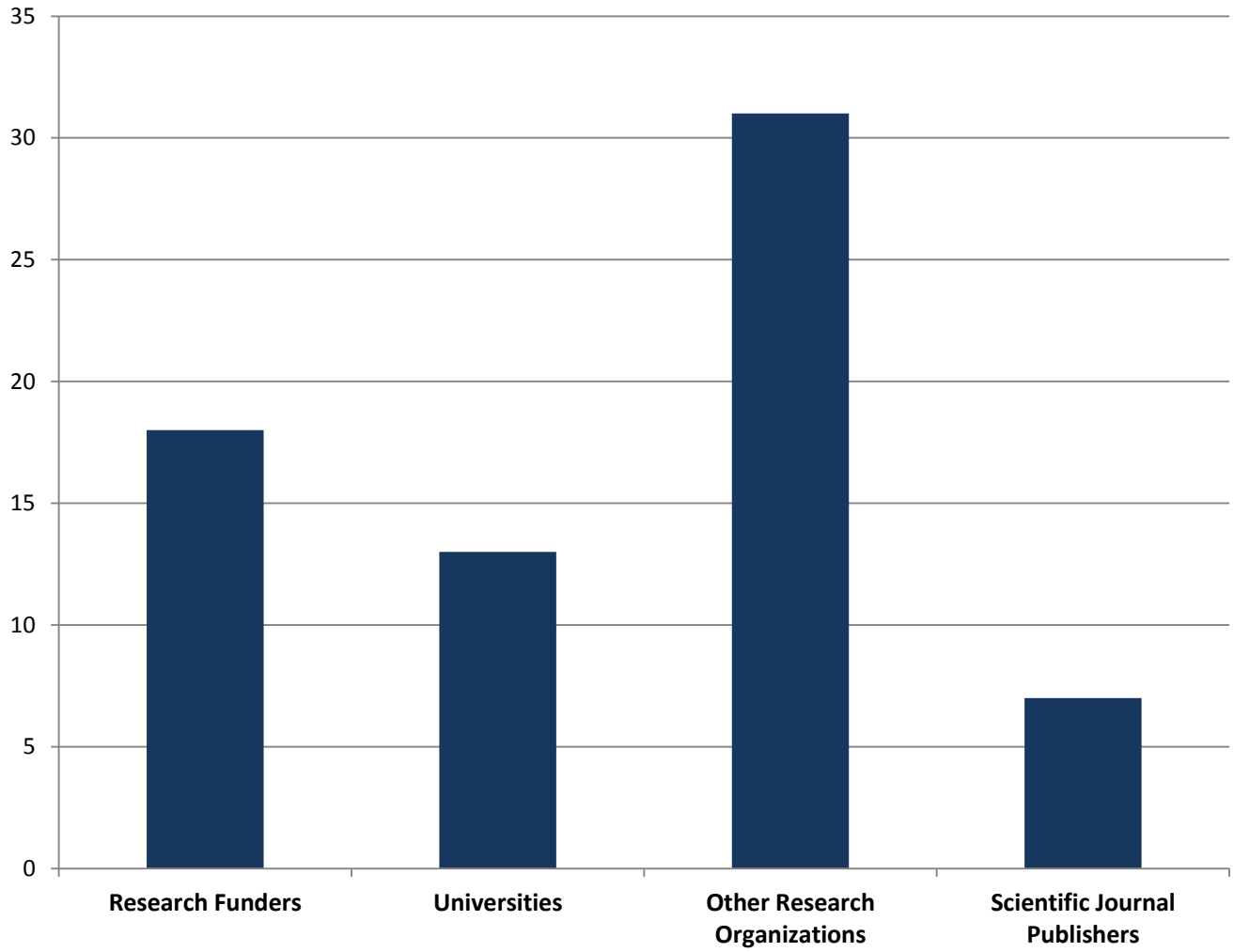
- Researchers in nearly half of the countries reports that they are met with data sharing requirements but receive no support or motivation to comply with requirements
- Policy enforcement, acknowledgement and rewards are more or less non-existent
- Existence of data repositories in the majority of countries indicate that data sharing activities are occurring

Research Funders Policies – Major Findings

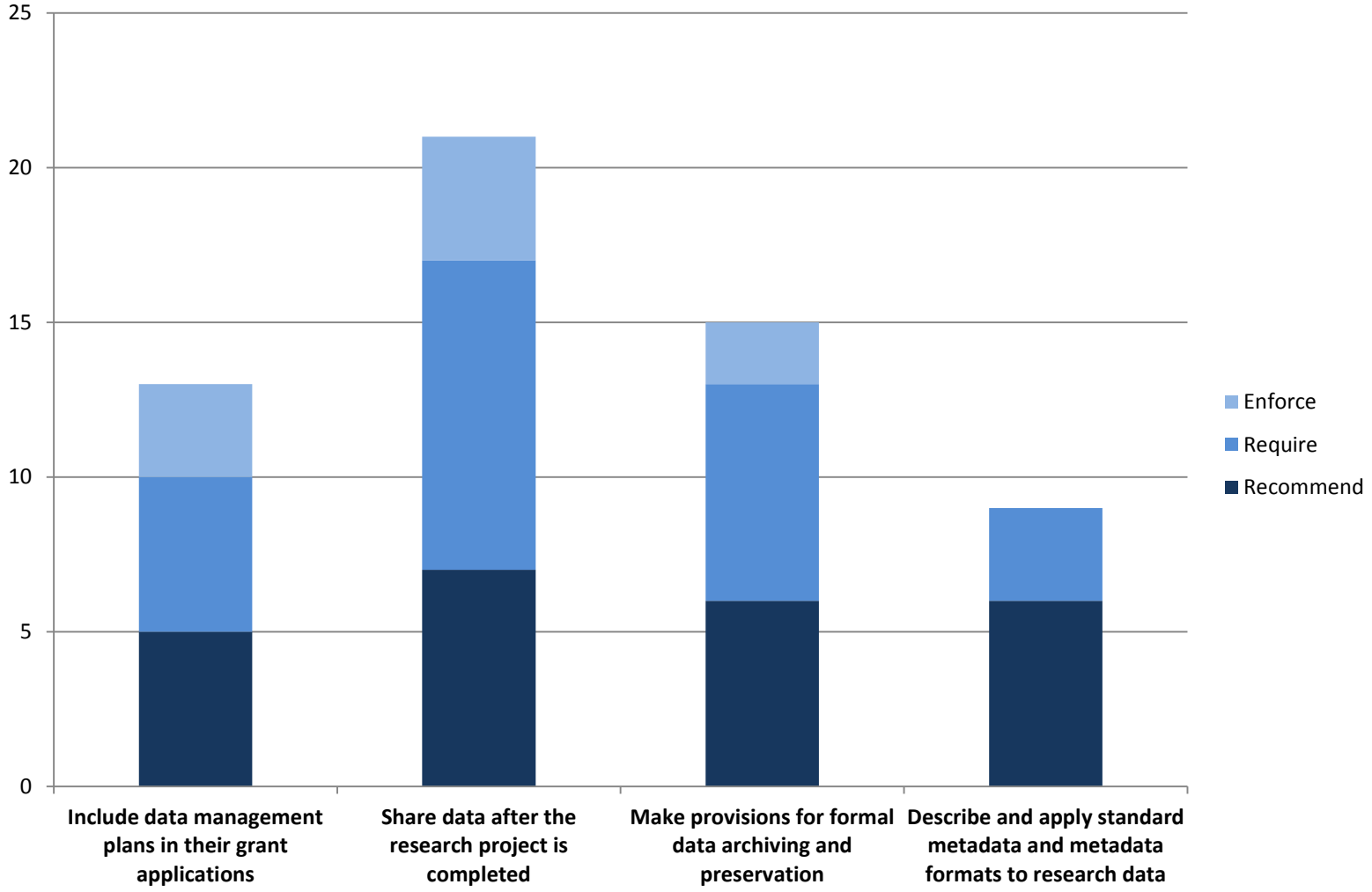
For those countries that reported that no such data sharing requirements exists

- **Lack of culture** - the most cited reason
- **No established policy**
- Lack of infrastructure, funding
- Data treated as private ownership
- Lack of awareness, motivation…

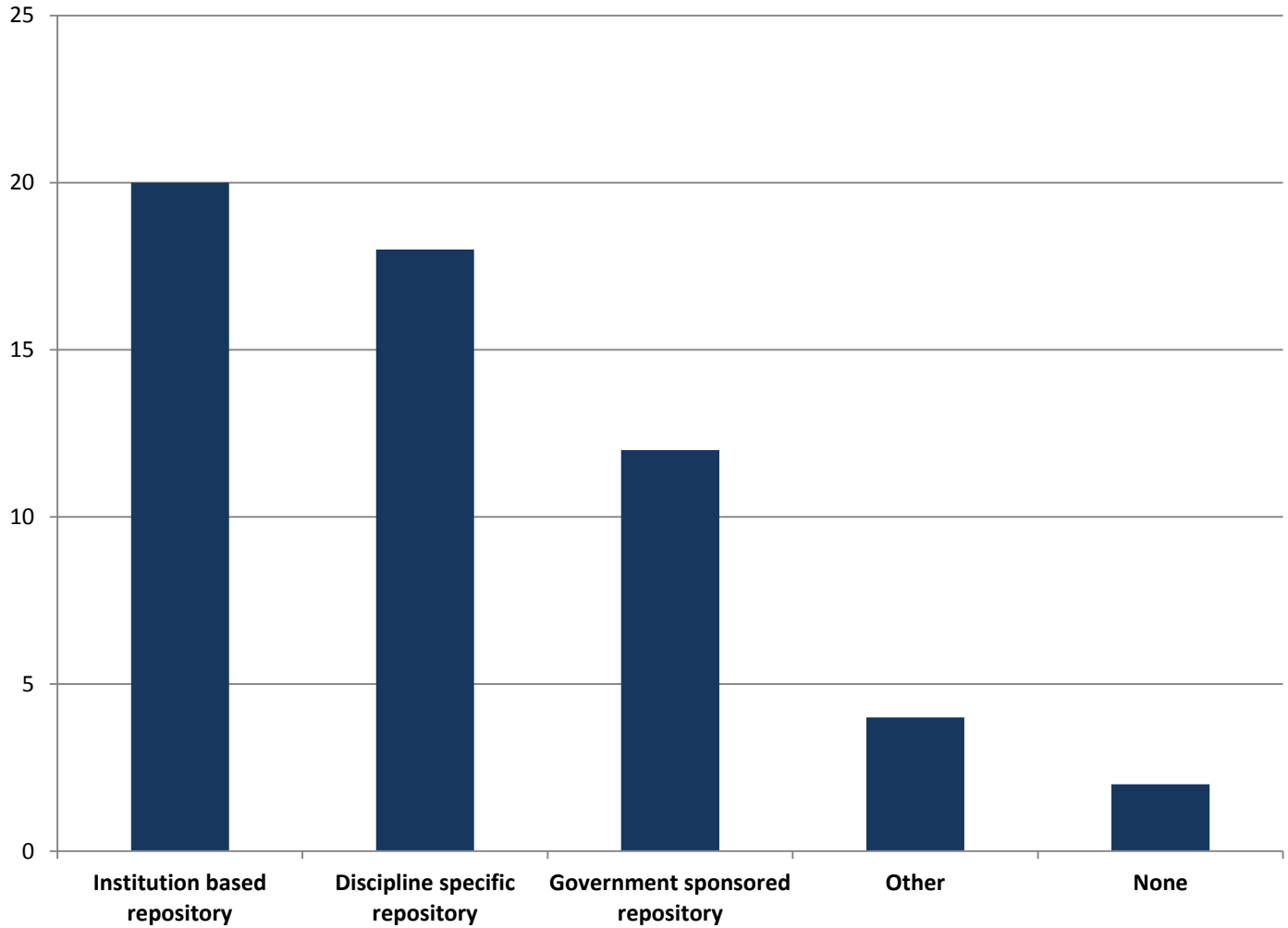
How common it is that the following organizations operating in your country have issued requirements promoting data sharing in SSH disciplines?
Answers = “Somewhat Common” and “Very Common”



Please indicate if any of the major SSH research funders operating in your country recommend, require, and/or enforce the following measures to promote data sharing



If social scientists working in your country have newly-generated data and would like to share these data with the academic community, which of the following infrastructures for sharing are presently easily available to them?



Common Challenges and needs

Looking at the overall picture:

- In many countries high-level policy recommendations has not yet led to specified national policies by key research funders.
- If SSH funders has formulated open access policies, they are likely to be soft recommendations without well defined requirements and guidance to follow-up and implementation of recommendations.

Common Challenges and needs

Looking at the overall picture:

- it is still unusual to enforce projects to open their data - we need to move form policy statements to policy **enforcements and monitoring**
- too many countries lack sufficient data sharing infrastructures – we need to move from short-term funding to long-term funding a business models that build **trust, confidence and incentives** to contribute to the data infrastructure.

SSH are well placed to develop common solutions for data management and sharing

CLARIN

DARIAH-EU

European Social Survey

Yesterday

SHARE Survey of Health, Ageing and Retirement in Europe 50+ in Europe

cessda

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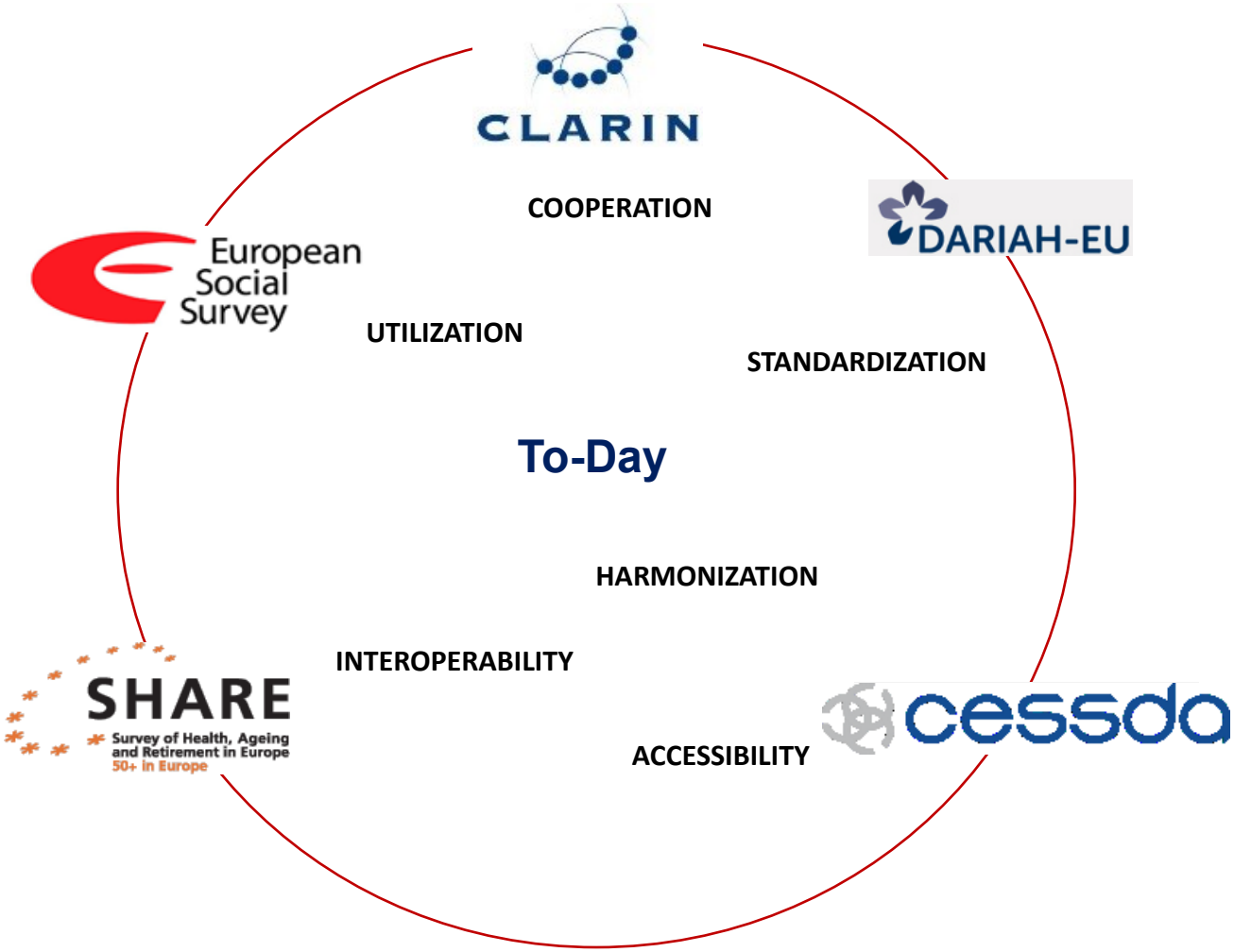
Towards an Infrastructural System – Cluster DASISH



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IFDO Data Policy Description Sheet

Topic	Nr.	Topic Item
Background information	1	Name of funder
Background information	2	Homepage
General policy	3	General conditions
General policy	4	Data Management Plan (DMP) for Proposal
General policy	5	Data Timeframe
General policy	6	Guidance
General policy	7	Compliance/Monitoring
General policy	8	Funding / Costs
General policy	9	Scope of policy
Standards/Documentation	10	Documentation Requirements
Standards/Documentation	11	Data Standards
Standards/Documentation	12	Metadata Standards
Access and preservation	13	Data Preservation
Access and preservation	14	Scope of preservation provisons
Access and preservation	15	Data Access / Sharing
Access and preservation	16	Data Access / Sharing incentives
Access and preservation	17	Data Sharing Rights (IPR)
Access and preservation	18	Data Embargo / Data Retention
Access and preservation	19	Data Sharing requirements / timeframe
Access and preservation	20	Designated Data Repository
Access and preservation	21	Data Repository Supported
Access and preservation	22	Institutional (data repository) Requirements
Publications	23	Open Access to Publications
Publications	24	Publication Repository Specified
Publications	25	Publication Repository Supported
Resources/References	26	Date of policy
Resources/References	27	Policy link
Resources/References	28	Policy link

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IFDO Data Policy Description Sheet - example

Input, short.	Input, free text (elaborate from previous column)	Direct quotes / paraphrased information from policy	Links to documents containing quote(s) / paraphrase(s)
-	**Research Council of Norway**		
-	http://www.forskningsradet.no/en/		
Well described	Applies to all projects funded totally or partly by the Norwegian Research Council		
Suggested / Not stated	Refers to 'progress report', not data management plan.	*"With regard to the use of research infrastructure for research involving the processing of large amounts of data (time series, registries, scientific collections, etc.), the progress report shall also show how the data generated are safeguarded through large-scale storage resources, data handling tools and dedicated point-to-point network connections for particularly demanding applications."*	R&D Project Agreement Document
Not stated			
Not stated			
Not stated			
Not stated			
Suggested	Applies to all research data	*"As a general rule, the formal applicant to the Research Council is to be a Norwegian institution/enterprise with a specific individual designated as the project administrator".*	General application requirements
Not stated			
Not stated			
Not stated			
Suggested / Recommended	All data and documentation to be deposited at designated data centre	*"Unless otherwise agreed with the Research Council, copies of all research-generated data, including requisite documentation, shall be transferred from the Project Owner to the Norwegian Social Science Data Services. This shall be carried out as soon as possible and at the latest two years following the conclusion of the project period.*	R&D Project Agreement Document
Suggested	Applies to all research data	*See quote in input nr 13*	
Not stated			
Not stated			
Not stated/Suggested	Indirectly and externally, through NSD licence/deposit form.		
Not stated			
Required	All research-generated data; as soon as possible, max. two years.	*See quote in input nr 13*	
Required	Norwegian Social Science Data Services (NSD)	*See quote in input nr 13*	
Not stated/Suggested	Indirectly, NSD (financial support)		
Not stated			
Well described / Required		*"Scientific publications based on R&D projects funded wholly or partially by the Research Council must be made openly accessible to all interested parties".*	The Research Council's Principles for Open Access to Scientific Publications
Not stated			
Not stated			
-	2009, 2012		

IFDO Data Policy Description Sheet

- So far, received DPDS from Denmark, Finland, Germany, Japan, Norway, Switzerland and USA.
- Preliminary findings in line with the survey: most countries' funders seem to be relatively weak on concrete requirements and implementation of recommendations.
- Hopefully, more countries will fill out the DPDS in the following months.

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Thank you for listening!